Kitchen Transparency: Proof of Progress

Prepared 22 October 2026 by Rishika Uppalapati

Summary

The Kitchen Transparency prototype is built, tested and published on GitHub. A restaurant manager can run AI-checked kitchen check-ins on a phone, and a diner sees the verified result next to the restaurant's raid history. The only step left is deploying it on Vercel, which needs my own Vercel login and API key entry. In the 12 commits listed below, made between 10:17 and 13:38 IST on 22 October 2026, the project grew to 75 tracked files and about 4,500 lines of code.
Code: https://github.com/Rishikauppalapati/AI-kitchen-transparency-
Live site: not deployed yet. Suggested Vercel name: kitchen-transparency (kitchen-transparency.vercel.app looked unclaimed when checked).

What the product does

Restaurants do daily kitchen check-ins in a manager view. Diners see when the kitchen was last verified, which checks passed, any past raid and how it was resolved, plus booking and ordering. The AI call is real: each photo is judged by Google's Gemini model through one server route, and the API key never reaches the browser.

Build timeline

Time (IST)	Commit	What was added
10:40	e3fd336	First one-screen MVP: photo upload and AI kitchen check
11:50	27f323a	Steps 1 and 2: phone-first shell, theme, navigation, and the diner screens (restaurant page, three raid states, booking, delivery page, news, report a problem)
11:59	5174116	Step 3: manager screens (home with progress ring, six-tile dining check with OTP sign-off, delivery check, complaints inbox)
12:15	7556073	Step 4: saved state and rules

Time (IST)	Commit	What was added
		(draft versus published, freshness bands, retake flags, demo clock, Reset demo, complaint loop between roles)
12:42	3977f8b	Step 5: the real Gemini photo check, with upload validation, timeouts and model fallback
12:55	f685d3a	Step 6: demo photo library with a clear message for missing files
13:05	dff2868	Three tested demo photos, and a fix so the AI's status always agrees with its note
13:14	0e921c4	Step 7: notifications (banner, bell list, triggers, automatic schedule)
13:22	a2833e6	Step 8: accessibility fixes, production rehearsal, deployment steps
13:34	5e3187e	Automatic demo notifications, and a trimmed demo panel for the Diner view
13:38	0765b76	Auto notifications slowed to one every 2 minutes and no longer pile up

What works today

- Phone-first app in a 390px frame, with Manager and Diner roles, bottom navigation and a demo control panel.
- Three sample restaurants (all fictional and labelled sample): one with a resolved raid, one with an unresolved raid, and one with no raid.
- Manager dining check with five AI photo tiles and a typed fridge reading judged by plain code (5 degrees C or lower).
- Manager delivery check with shift setup, random pack checks with a 10-minute countdown, and a simulated platform-data section.
- A diner page that changes only when the manager signs off with all checks green (demo code 1234), so a failing or unfinished check never reaches the diner.
- Freshness bands (green, amber, grey) driven by a demo clock that can be fast-forwarded.
- Complaints reported by a diner appear in the manager inbox, and the recorded fix appears in the diner's history.
- Real news items, worded as reported and linked to their sources.
- Reminder notifications: a sliding banner with a Start button, a bell list, trigger buttons, and

an optional automatic mode.

Tests passed

Test	Result
T1 A tidy demo photo turns its tile green	Passed with the handwash_tidy photo through the real AI. Other tidy photos are not added yet, so their green result is simulated.
T2 An untidy photo turns amber with a note and Retake	Passed, real AI
T3 With an amber or unfinished tile, Last verified does not change	Passed
T4 All six green plus OTP 1234 updates the diner page	Passed, including on the production build
T5 Three failed attempts raise Flagged for review	Passed, visible to the manager only
T6 Fast-forward makes the diner page stale	Passed
T7 Delivery setup and pack checks; a failed setup changes nothing	Passed
T8 The three raid states	Passed
T9 Not-a-kitchen photo, a PDF and an oversized file	Passed, each gives a clear message and changes nothing
T10 The API key appears nowhere except .env.local	Passed: checked in 481 project and build files, downloaded files, API responses, headers and git history

Evidence from the real AI

Demo photo	AI answer
handwash_tidy	Pass: soap dispenser and wash basin visible (5 of 5 runs)
handwash_untidy	Fail: wash basin visible, but no soap dispenser visible (5 of 5 runs after the consistency fix)
bins_untidy	Fail: bin is overflowing and open (every run)
caps_gloves_untidy	Fail: no caps or gloves visible
not_a_kitchen	Not relevant: photo does not show this

Two photos were removed after real-AI testing showed they did not behave as a tidy example: the chefs photo for caps and gloves, and the alley dumpsters for bins.

Accessibility and safety checks

- Text contrast is at least 4.5 to 1 for every colour pair used, checked by calculation. Form field borders are at least 3 to 1.
- Every tap target is at least 44px across all 19 screens and sheets checked, and every control has a name.
- Status never relies on colour alone: every state also has an icon and words.
- Bottom sheets keep keyboard focus inside, close with Escape and return focus to the button that opened them.
- Uploads are checked by type, size and file signature in the browser and again on the server. Photos are shrunk to 1024px before upload.

Known limits

- Only 8 of the 20 demo photos exist. Missing ones show an Add this photo message, with a clearly labelled simulated result as a fallback.
- Google's Gemini service was slow at times during testing (some requests took more than 15 seconds). The route times out cleanly and tries backup models.
- Demo data is saved per browser, so there is no shared database.
- A real screen reader has not been tested yet.

Next steps

- Deploy on Vercel: import the GitHub repository, add the GEMINI_API_KEY environment variable in Vercel's settings, and deploy.
- Add clear tidy photos for the remaining demo images.
- Rotate the Gemini API key after the hackathon.